

THE IMPLEMENTATION OF THE REGULATORY FUNCTIONS OF THE PHARMACISTS COUNCIL OF NIGERIA (PCN) in respect of EDUCATION AND CONTINUING PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT (CPD) PROGRAMMES

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PREAMBLE

The Pharmacists Council of Nigeria(PCN) is the Federal Government Agency Establishment by ACT CAP P 17, LFN 2004 and charged with the regulation of Pharmacy education, training and practice in all its aspects and ramifications.

There are two (2) cadres in the Pharmacy profession namely:

Pharmacists

Pharmacy Technicians

While the pharmacists are trained in the approved Universities for minimum of five years (B. Pharm) or six years (pharm D), Pharmacy Technicians are trained in colleges/schools of health technology for a minimum of three (3) years as certified Pharmacy technicians.



Preamble continued

The key functions of PCN in the training of pharmacists and Pharmacy technicians includes:

Determining the standard of knowledge and skills to be attained by persons seeking to become a pharmacist or Pharmacy technician Nigeria.

Approving institutions whose pharmacists or Pharmacy technician could be trained in Nigeria.

Approving any qualification granted by foreign institutions for the purpose of practice in Nigeria.



Preamble continued

The outline of this Paper include responsibilities of the PCN in:

Pharmacy education and continuing professional development (CPD)

Development of the Benchmark Minimum Academic Standard (BMAS) for the undergraduate Pharmacy degree program

Accreditation of school of pharmacies

Internship training

Pre-registration Examination for interns

Foreign Pharmacy Graduate Orientation Program (FPGOP)

Mandatory Continuing Professional Development (MCPD)



Preamble continued

Pharmacy Technician (PT) Education

Accreditation of schools/colleges of health technologies

Development of course content for the PT education

Administering the National Pre-Certification examination for PTs

Development of course content for the CPD program for holders of PT Permit



Preamble continued

Training of Patent and Proprietary Medicine Vendors License (PPMVLs)

Developing course content for the Orientation Program for newly licensed holders of the PPMVL

Developing course content for the Refresher Training for holders of the PPMVL



PCN RESPONSIBILITIES RELATED TO PHARMACY EDUCATION

Benchmark Minimum Academic Standard (BMAS) for the undergraduate Pharmacy degree programs (BPharm and Pharm D)

The PCN is responsible for the Minimum Academic Requirements (MAR) for the Bachelor of Pharmacy (B.Pharm) and Doctor of Pharmacy (Pharm D) degree program.

The PCN, through its Deans Committee prepare the MAR and pass it to the Education Committee. The Education Committee recommends it to the Governing Council for approval. Once approved, it is forwarded to the national Universities Commission (NUC) for the preparation of the BMAS.

Passing of the approved BMAS to the Faculties of Pharmacy/pharmaceutical Sciences, through the Vice Chancellors, for implementation.

The BMAS is subject to periodic review every five years.



PCN RESPONSIBILITIES RELATED TO PHARMACY EDUCATION of Pharmacy schools

Developing and reviewing scoring formats for the accreditation of undergraduate Pharmacy degrees

It is designed to reduce subjective assessment and create uniformity in the standards of assessing the facilities and human resources in any faculty

The scoring format is the assessment tool used in scoring the performance of faculties in terms of manpower and facilities



PCN RESPONSIBILITIES RELATED TO PHARMACY EDUCATION

Accreditation of Pharmacy schools

- The scoring format collects information related to:
- Human resources: Academics (professional and nonprofessionals) and Non-academic (administrative and technical)
- Professionals: Senior academics (lecturers I and above)
- Facilities (building): Offices, classrooms, and laboratories
- Teaching support facilities: Library, herbarium, botanical garden, and animal house



PCN RESPONSIBILITIES RELATED TO PHARMACY EDUCATION

Accreditation of Pharmacy schools

The Education Committee constitute and recommend the accreditation team to the Governing Council for approval

The report of every accreditation visit is considered and recommended to the Governing Council by Education Committee



PCN RESPONSIBILITIES RELATED TO PHARMACY EDUCATION

Regulation of Internship training program

Internship training is a one-year compulsory experiential training for Pharmacy graduates in Nigeria.

Developing minimum requirements for accrediting facilities for internship training program

It starts after the induction ceremony and can be undertaken in any PCN approved facility such as:

Hospitals

Pharmaceutical industries

Community pharmacies

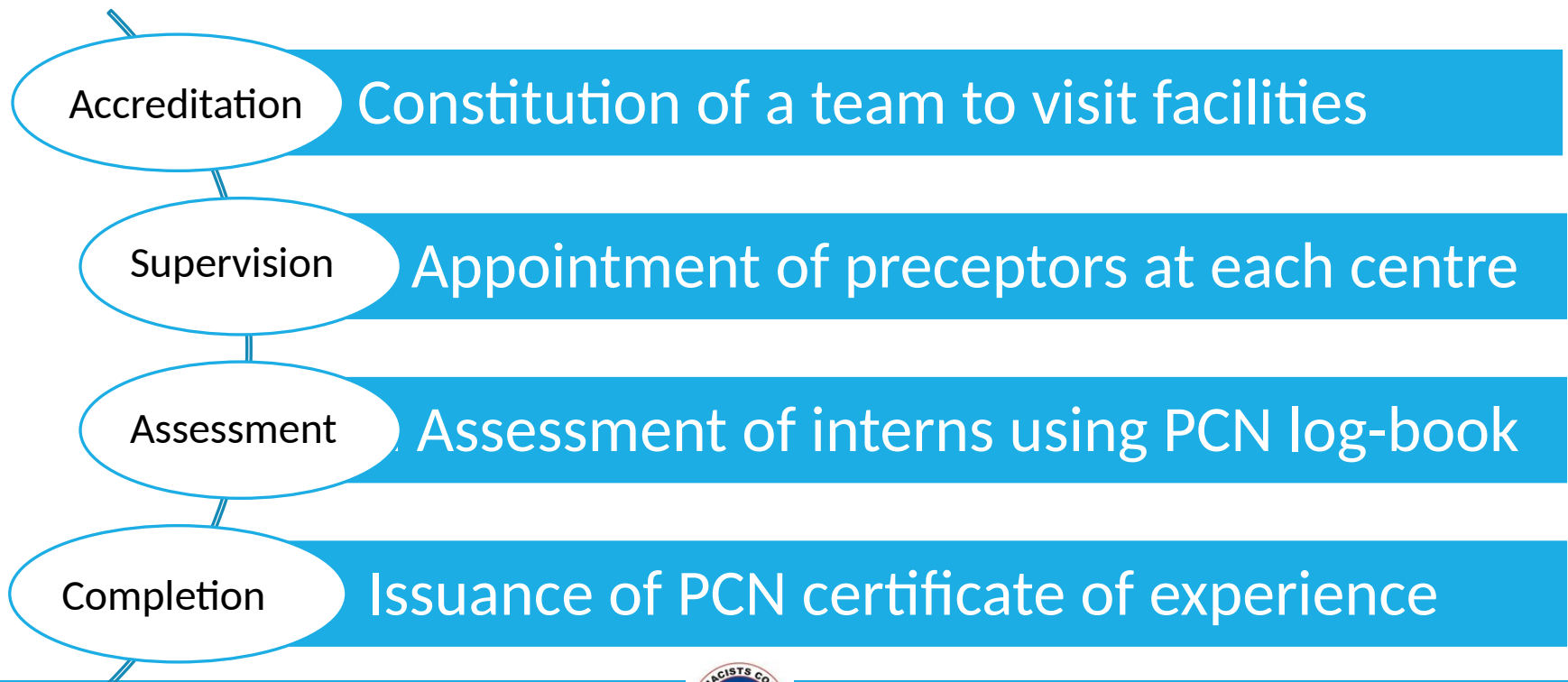
Faculties of Pharmacy

Ministries, Departments and Agencies(MDAs) Government



PCN RESPONSIBILITIES RELATED TO PHARMACY EDUCATION

Regulation of Internship training program



PCN RESPONSIBILITIES RELATED TO PHARMACY EDUCATION

PRE-REGISTRATION EXAMINATION

The pre- registration examination (PEP) was introduced by the PCN for Intern Pharmacists towards the end of their training programs

The PEP was approved by the Governing Council in 2015

The first examination was conducted in October 2017

The PEP is a quality assurance tool adopted by PCN to strengthen our standards in line with global best practices



PCN RESPONSIBILITIES RELATED TO PHARMACY EDUCATION

The Council has a committee that sets the questions in line with the approved curriculum

Developing course content and administering the Pre-registration Examination

The examination is written as a computer-based test at designated centers

Results are collated and presented to the Council through the Education Committee for approval

Successful candidates are registered to practice Pharmacy in Nigeria.



PCN RESPONSIBILITIES RELATED PHARMACY EDUCATION

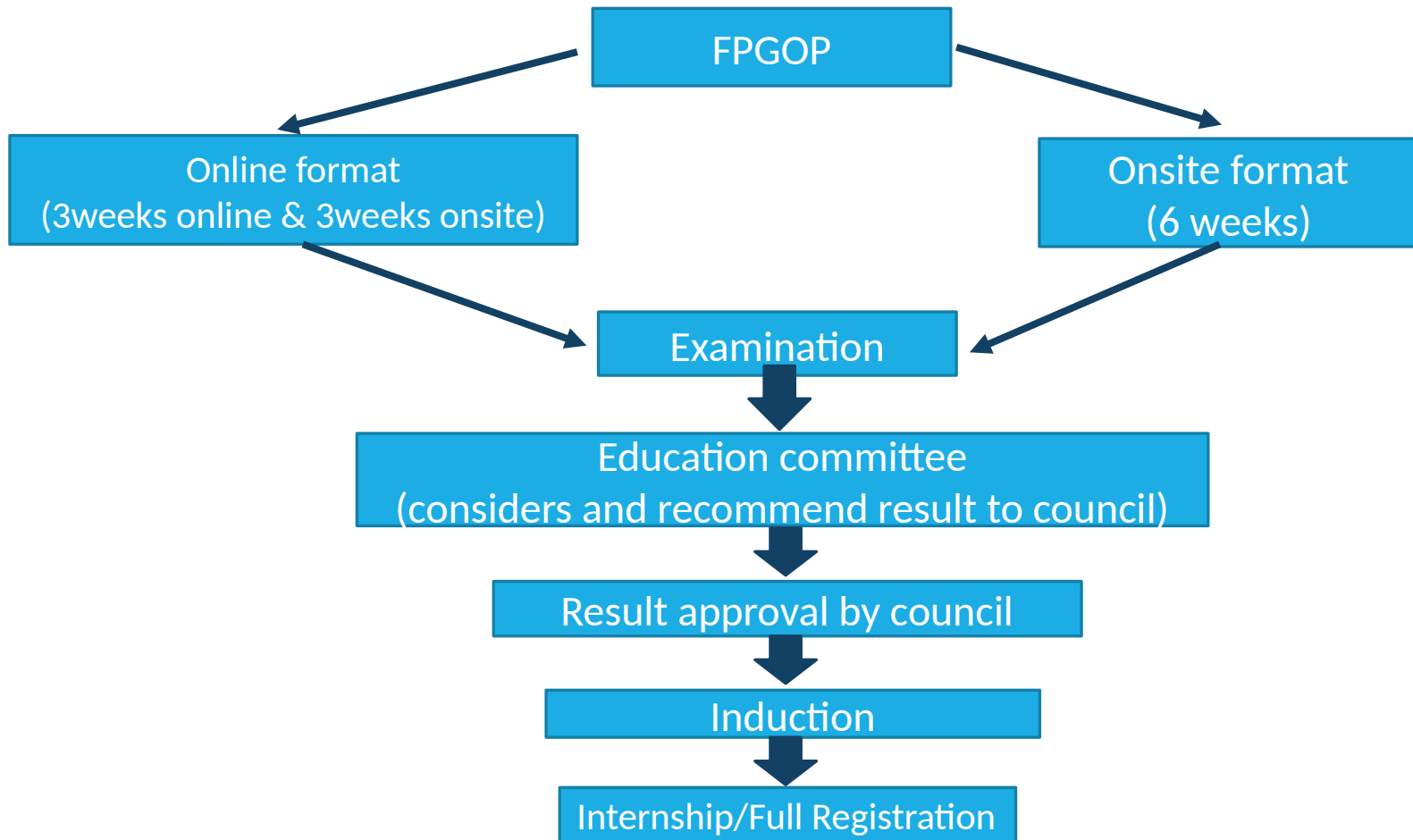
FOREIGN PHARMACY GRADUATE ORIENTATION PROGRAM (FPGOP)

The FPGOP is a program for Nigerian pharmacist trained in overseas Universities and wishes to be registered to practice in Nigeria

The PCN is responsible for developing course content for accessing foreign trained Pharmacy graduates



Steps for registering Foreign trained pharmacists by PCN



PCN RESPONSIBILITIES RELATED PHARMACY EDUCATION

TO MANDATORY CONTINUING PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT (MCPD)

The PCN is fully responsible for the MCPD:

Development and reviews of MCPD modular System

Designing the MCPD courses, curriculum, and modules. MCPD topics address contemporary advancements in Pharmacy

Accreditation of MCPD provider centers

Development of course content, credit points, face-to-face and online conferences, workshops, seminars and trainings

Implementation of online Continuing Professional Development platform

Allocation of credit points to eligible pharmacists who completed the MCPD programs



PCN RESPONSIBILITIES RELATED TO PHARMACY TECHNICIAN (PT) EDUCATION

The Pharmacy Technician (PT) program is a middle level cadre in the Pharmacy profession

The PT training curriculum is approved by the Governing Council

It is a 3-year training at Colleges/Schools of Health Technology

The training Sub-Committee of PCN is responsible for the development of curriculum

The curriculum consist of basic science courses as well as courses such as principles of PT practice, basic dispensing, action and uses of medicines, primary health care and anatomy and physiology.

A minimum of six months experiential learning at hospitals and community pharmacies



PCN RESPONSIBILITIES RELATED TO PHARMACY TECHNICIAN (PT) EDUCATION

Administration of the National Pre-Certification Examination for Pharmacy Technician

The Pharmacy Technician Program is a three (3) year training conducted at Colleges of Health Technology that leads to the award of Certified Pharmacy Technician Certificate

The PCN has the Responsibilities of conducting the examination and it is usually held once in a year

For a candidate to qualify to write the examination, he/she must have passed through a PCN accredited College of Health Technology

The training Committee of PCN constitute an Ad hoc Committee made of Heads of Department of approved College of Health Technology



PCN RESPONSIBILITIES RELATED TO PHARMACY TECHNICIAN (PT)

EDUCATION Administration of the National Pre-Certification Examination for Pharmacy Technician

The Ad hoc Committee sets the questions which is administered by PCN

Result is moderated by the Ad hoc Committee and passed to Training Committee for recommendation to the Governing Council through the education Committee.

The Council approves the result, which is released to the candidates via their respective Colleges.

Successful candidates are inducted as Certified Pharmacy Technicians in Nigeria.

Foreign Trained Pharmacy Technicians are assessed, and their certificate evaluated before participating in the National Examination.



PCN RESPONSIBILITIES RELATED TO PHARMACY TECHNICIAN (PT) CEP

Development of course content for the CPD program for holders of Pharmacy Technician Permit

The PCN is responsible for the development course content for the Continuing Professional Development (CPD) program for holders of Pharmacy Technician Permit;

The PCN is currently reviewing the guideline for the MCEP for Pharmacy Technicians. The review includes development of manuals, facilitator' guides and slides for Pharmacy Technicians MCEP.



RESPONSIBILITY OF THE PCN RELATED TO PPMVL TRAINING

Development of course content for the Orientation Program of newly licensed holders of the Patent and Proprietary Medicine Vendors License (PPMVL)

The PCN as the licensing and regulatory authority has the Responsibilities for producing course content for the Orientation Program for newly licensed holders of the Patent and Proprietary Medicine Vendors License (PPMVL) in Nigeria;

Educating PPMVs on the legal and regulatory considerations governing the vending of patent medicines in Nigeria

Educating vendors on their operational responsibilities



Newly licensed holders of the Patent and Proprietary Medicine Vendors License (PPMVL)

Educating the PPMVL holders on elementary aspects of product procurement and handling

Preparing and reviewing the approved patent medicine list

Organizing orientation programs for new PPMVL license holders

Development of course content for the refresher training for licensed PMVs

Organizing CEP for licensed PMVs who have undertaken the PCN orientation program

Development of manual for the orientation and CEP program.



CONCLUSION

You can add the conclusion statement here

S/N	PCN APPROVED FACILITIES	NUMBER
1	Approved School of Pharmacies	
2	Approved Colleges/School of Health Technologies	
3	Accredited MCPD Provider Centres	
4	Accredited Internship training centres	

THANK YOU

